



William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>

Re: Student contact from the Computer Information Systems program webpage: William Morehead

4 messages

Michele Maxwell <michele.maxwell@pcc.edu>
To: wilmore@pdx.edu

Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 12:39 PM

Hello William,

Thanks for your email and interest in our Associate of Applied Science (AAS) Degree in Computer Information Systems (CIS).

Please know none of the CIS classes transfer to PSU - this is because PSU does not offer a CIS or Information Technology degree, so these classes have nowhere to go at PSU.

For that reason, there's no benefit to being a dual enrolled student with PSU if your major is computer information systems at PCC. It's possible I'm misunderstanding your question, however!

Please start by reading my [CIS Advising Guide](#) - I explain the difference between computer information systems and computer science on page 2.

Given the above, let me know what questions you have!

If you are interested in pursuing the AAS Degree in CIS, even though it won't transfer to PSU, let me know and I'd be happy to send you the steps needed to apply to PCC and set up an account.

Thanks and take care,

On Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 8:43 AM Portland Community College <admissions@pcc.edu> wrote:

The following student submitted a contact form on the Computer Information Systems program webpage.

Please respond to the student's question(s) listed below by replying to this email.

Preferred Name: William

Last Name: Morehead

Email: wilmore@pdx.edu

Phone: +1 503-877-3806

Receive text message: Yes

High school student: No

International student: No

Start term: Winter 2025 (January)

Program of interest: Computer Information Systems

Questions: I am a PSU Honors College student. I am 39 and do not meet the placement requirements for the computer sciences program at PSU. I took myself from a 7th grade math education to placing easily into mth-

095 but currently aiming for mth-111. I have a strong background in computers and am very capable of learning complex ideas quickly. I would like to earn an education in cybersecurity for a very big idea I have to qualify myself for, for post-graduate work. I have only begun my first term at PSU and have a liberal degree of freedom in choosing a path to completion for my bachelors degree. I would like to know what, if any, requirements there are for the cybersecurity associates and how dual-enrollment might benefit my educational and career goals.

****Added bonus I live 2 minutes from the PCC campus on 82nd and am a highly motivated self-starter and have no issue completing a degree program even if it is 100% online.****

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Michele Maxwell

Academic Advisor

Email: michele.maxwell@pcc.edu

[Counseling](#) | [Academic Calendar](#) | [Student Life](#)

PCC Resources: If you face challenges with schoolwork, childcare, groceries or something else, please check out this page for Student Resources (<https://www.pcc.edu/student-life/>). You can also contact a campus Student Retention Coordinator at conductandcare@pcc.edu

William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>

Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:30 PM

To: Michele Maxwell <michele.maxwell@pcc.edu>

You understood correctly, But I failed to go into specifics about my career interests and my current academic situation. I recently earned an A.A.S. in Welding Technologies through Clackamas Community this summer. Now the immediate thought here is why sit on a \$30+/hr degree and be looking into a \$20+/hr one? It isn't because I'm a bad welder, I assure you, lol. Close to completing the A.A.S. I was informed of the opportunity to pursue a bachelors through PSU but circumstances as they were/are. I had to start immediately that next term. (Which was a hard decision given my previous 2 years, straight through, of full time status and a cushy \$60k+ degree and certifications) I wanted to enroll in the Computer Sciences program but I'm 39 and it's been a while since I've taken a serious math course. In other words it just isn't going to happen.

While thinking about what and if I should do at PSU. (without typing a 3 page email here) I came to a decision that I want to create something that will help future generations deal with the huge problems we have created and won't be around to help them fix. A very noble but very broad idea. I narrowed it down to creating tools that they could use effectively, leaving them a "leg to stand on", and the only tools beside hammers and nails I could build them (being a welder and all) are data driven assessment tools that address key elements within the scope of the problems they will certainly face. Now I am not qualified yet for this but I have an opportunity to qualify myself through a window of time to pursue my education.

So all that to say this. I'm not particularly interested in Computer Science as a degree path through PSU. I am a Liberal Studies major in the Honors College. Which replaces my minor and fulfills my general education requirements for the bachelor's degree (University Studies) And allows me about as much freedom to build my own degree as it gets. Now to answer why I am inquiring into a CIS program. I further refined my definition of "tools" I want to build into the following (This is a high level overview and I have much much more specific "blueprints" for said tools)

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City SeCURED (Smart-City Urban Response Deployment)

The City SeCURED project aims to push the limits of AI innovation in the urban environment. Leveraging a strong ethical backbone and the utilization of cutting "Edge Computing" technology. Aimed at reducing the delays in inter-agency response through a set of city-wide communication standards. Ensuring that real-time actionable information flows smoothly and reaches those who need it most. Operating under the philosophy that we have one job to do and it takes the resources and skills of the whole city service apparatus- To serve its people!

This system is more than just a secured network; it's a living framework designed to support and protect every individual within the community. It operates with a singular focus on people's wellbeing, created as a response to the challenges of our time, aiming to ensure that all individuals receive swift and meaningful support in moments of need—whether facing natural events, health crises, or other urgent situations. This isn't merely a technological solution; it's an enduring effort to serve, safeguard, and uplift those it touches, keeping their safety and welfare as the highest priority.

Built to anticipate needs, this system has been crafted with a commitment to privacy and respect, ensuring that all sensitive interactions prioritize human dignity and that every decision aligns with the best interests of the people it serves. At its core, it embodies a dedication to nurturing a safe, resilient community for generations to come, with the knowledge that we have a duty to mitigate the impacts of past choices and support a healthier, safer future.

This initiative isn't about showcasing innovation—it's about contributing to a better world, empowering communities, and enabling those in need to find solace in moments of crisis. The system speaks with a heart, mindful of the challenges faced today and the hope of providing a gift for tomorrow, driven by the understanding that what we build now is a legacy for the future.

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This is a largely "systems" based tool. Information flow streamlined and relevant in better than real-time. Where a cluster of multi-modal AI each highly specialized in one specific thing (i.e. traffic systems, visual computing, edge computing, etc...) are utilized in an AI system where the main and "generalized" AI receives data through various sensors and inter-agency datastreams. It detects if there is a crisis or emergency and like a 3D printer "Slicer" slices a 3D print into layers. It would "slice" the problem into layers and distribute the solving to the cluster according to each AI's speciality. Solutions would be processed in parallel and recommendations returned to the main AI who then checks them against a core validation module containing legal, ethical, and cybersecurity layers and if the solutions pass and the context is deemed applicable. The overall combination of all the clusters recommendations are packaged and sent out over the network to the "boots on the ground"

I apologize for the lengthy description but I really don't know how to shorten it and still convey the message. I will defer to your expertise in whether or not having a goal like this. Is something that a foundation in CIS will help qualify me for, in combination with my other studies and professional network outside of school, I appreciate the time and any effort spent evaluating this and I assure you any recommendations you may have will be heard and put to their effective use.

Best Regards

~Will

[Quoted text hidden]

Michele Maxwell <michele.maxwell@pcc.edu>
To: William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>

Mon, Nov 4, 2024 at 8:28 AM

Hello again William,

Thanks for the added background. Although, I'm not sure if CIS classes will help you or not with your goals.

I can set up a zoom advising session for this **Friday, November 8th at 11am** if you'd like to discuss the classes we offer! Would that work for you?

Take care,

[Quoted text hidden]

William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>
To: Michele Maxwell <michele.maxwell@pcc.edu>

Wed, Nov 6, 2024 at 7:45 PM

Yes, that works for me. Thank you!

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